PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

YEAR 8 ENQUIRY • 1600–1783

The First British Empire (1600–1783)

Chartered Trade, Transatlantic Slavery, Maroon Resistance & The American Revolution



PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE • CORPORATE IMPERIAL STATECRAFT — Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773)

Following the 1757 Battle of Plassey and the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad, the East India Company transitioned from a maritime trading outfit into a military ruler collecting taxes from 20 million Bengalis. Nathaniel Dance portrayed Robert Clive not as an administrator, but as an imperial general:

1. STANCE OF IMPERIAL AUTHORITY:
Clive stands resolute in scarlet regimental uniform, sword belt fastened, projecting military command over Indian sovereign territories.

2. THE BENGAL BATTLEFIELD:
In the background, sepoy infantry drill beneath smoke and battle pennants, symbolising the privatised corporate army that conquered Bengal.

3. ROYAL & CORPORATE HONOURS:
Embroidered badges of the Order of the Bath honour Clive's elevation to the peerage funded by astronomical private plunder ('jagirs').

4. THE OBSCURED REALITY:
The painting glorifies military prestige while obscuring the horrific 1770 Bengal famine where corporate grain speculation devastated millions.

SCARLET COAT	DRAWN SWORD	BENGAL PLAIN
Crown recognition of Company military conquest.	Armed force as foundation of trade monopoly.	Vast territorial wealth seized from Mughals.

DISCIPLINARY SIGNIFICANCE: In 18th-century imperial expansion, portraiture transformed private corporate commanders into national martial heroes to justify unprecedented chartered monopolies to Parliament.

DISCIPLINARY HINGE QUESTION: HISTORICAL EVALUATION

Does this portrait portray Clive as an honourable servant of the British nation, or does it disguise a reckless corporate plunderer whose greed destabilised an entire subcontinent?

Primary Visual Evidence: *Major-General Robert Clive, Baron Clive of Plassey* • Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773) — NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: The East India Company & Mughal Bengal (1600–1757) *How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: The Transatlantic Slave Trade & The Middle Passage (1619–1807) *What were the economic mechanics and human horrors of the Triangular Trade?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: Plantation Reality, Queen Nanny & Maroon Resistance (1655–1740) *How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: The Thirteen Colonies & The Boston Tea Party (1763–1773) *Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The American Revolution & Black Loyalists (1775–1783) *How did colonial rebellion dismantle the First British Empire and reshape global liberty?*	☐	☐

How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1600–1615 • Why did Queen Elizabeth I grant a royal monopoly charter?

- 218 London Merchants
- Pepper & Cotton Cargo
- Private Trade Profits

2 1615–1700 • How did the Company establish fortified coastal factories in India?

- Emperor Jahangir
- Surat, Madras, Calcutta
- Armed Sepoy Garrisons

3 1756 • Why did tensions erupt into crisis with Nawab Siraj ud-Daulah?

- Mounting Heavy Cannons
- Siege of Fort William
- The Black Hole Dungeon

4 June 1757 • How did Robert Clive achieve victory at the Battle of Plassey?

- Secret Gold Bribes
- Heavy Monsoon Downpour
- Mir Jafar's Treason

5 1765–1770 • How did the 1765 Diwani transform a company into a sovereign ruler?

- Emperor Shah Alam II
- Collecting Land Revenue
- 1770 Bengal Famine

In 1600, the East India Company had one clerk; by 1770, it commanded an army twice the size of Britain's.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why the East India Company was able to expand its territorial control across Bengal and India between 1600 and 1765. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Royal charters granting trade monopolies and company private armies** | **The grant of the Diwani (1765) by Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A primary reason for this development was that... • In particular, a decisive factor was... • Furthermore, military events demonstrated that... • Crucially, an important turning point occurred when... • Consequently, this resulted in...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

East India Company • Robert Clive • Battle of Plassey (1757) • Diwani (1765) • Shah Alam II • Bengal • private army • corporate monopoly • tax extraction

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1600 East India Company Charter** and **1757 Battle of Plassey** nodes (corporate monopoly, Clive's Bengal coup, 1765 Diwani).

What were the economic mechanics and human horrors of the Triangular Trade?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1619–1672 • How did the Triangular Trade connect Britain, Africa, and the Americas?

- Manufactured Guns & Brass
- Kidnapped African Captives
- Raw Plantation Sugar

2 1672–1713 • How did royal monopolies and the Asiento expand British slaving?

- Royal African Company
- Branded Hot Iron RAC
- Spanish Asiento Contract

3 1713–1781 • What forensic conditions characterised the horrors of the Middle Passage?

- Chained on Wooden Shelves
- Iron Shackles & Collars
- Deadly Dysentery & Fevers

4 1781 • How did the Zong massacre expose the dehumanising logic of chattel slavery?

- Captain Luke Collingwood
- 133 Thrown Overboard
- Fraudulent Insurance Claim

5 1788–1807 • How did the Brookes diagram and Equiano's voice ignite abolitionism?

- Brookes Ship Diagram
- Equiano's Bestselling Book
- Abolition Act of 1807

The slave ship Brookes carried 454 people under legal regulation—and 609 when unregulated.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of conditions endured by enslaved Africans during the Middle Passage. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was… • Detail: Specifically, on slave ships captives were… • Feature 2: A second key feature was… • Detail: This caused horrific suffering because…

Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain one consequence of the Zong massacre (1781) for the British abolitionist movement. [4 marks]

Focus on how legal evidence from the trial influenced public debate and aided the campaign against the trade.

Analytical Connectives: *A significant consequence was that… • For instance, evidence demonstrated that… • Furthermore, this led directly to… • Consequently, public opinion…*

Key Terms: Zong massacre (1781) • Captain Collingwood • Granville Sharp • Gregson v Gilbert • human cargo • insurance fraud • abolitionist movement

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1672 Royal African Company & Middle Passage** node (Triangular Trade, Spanish Asiento, 1781 Zong & Brookes diagram).

How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1655 • How did Cromwell's conquest of Jamaica birth the Maroon communities?

- Western Design Invasion
- Escaping to Rainforests
- Blue Mountain Fortresses

2 1670–1730 • Why was sugar cultivation described as an agro-industrial death machine?

- Iron Crushing Rollers
- Overseer Cowhide Whips
- Exhaustion & Brutality

3 1680–1720 • How did enslaved labourers engage in daily sabotage and cultural survival?

- Breaking Tool Handles
- Feigning Sudden Sickness
- Anansi Trickster Tales

4 1720–1734 • How did Queen Nanny lead the Windward Maroons to military victory?

- Living Branch Camouflage
- Sounding the Abeng Horn
- Guerilla Ambush Tactics

5 1739–1740 • Why was the 1739 Peace Treaty both a triumph and a painful compromise?

- 1,500 Sovereign Acres
- British Truce White Flag
- Returning Enslaved Fugitives

Queen Nanny's warriors used tree branches as camouflage so well that redcoats thought the forest was attacking them.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • PLANTER EDWARD LONG, HISTORY OF JAMAICA (1774)

"The plantation negroes are naturally indolent and require the perpetual surveillance and discipline of the driver's whip to extract labour. Without European mastery, order would instantly dissolve into ruin."

INTERPRETATION 2 • HISTORIAN HILARY BECKLES, CARIBBEAN FREEDOM (2004)

"Enslaved Africans waged an unrelenting war of resistance through daily sabotage, spiritual preservation, and armed guerrilla struggle. Queen Nanny proved that African military strategy could humble the British imperial army."

Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the nature of enslaved African resistance. [4 marks] **PART B**

Sentence Stems: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on… • Interpretation 1 argues that… • In contrast, Interpretation 2 suggests that… • This is a difference because…

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the reality of plantation control. [4 marks] **PART C**

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: One reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ is because they have a different focus… • Specifically, Interpretation 1 focuses primarily on… • In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses more on… • As a result, the authors reach different conclusions because…

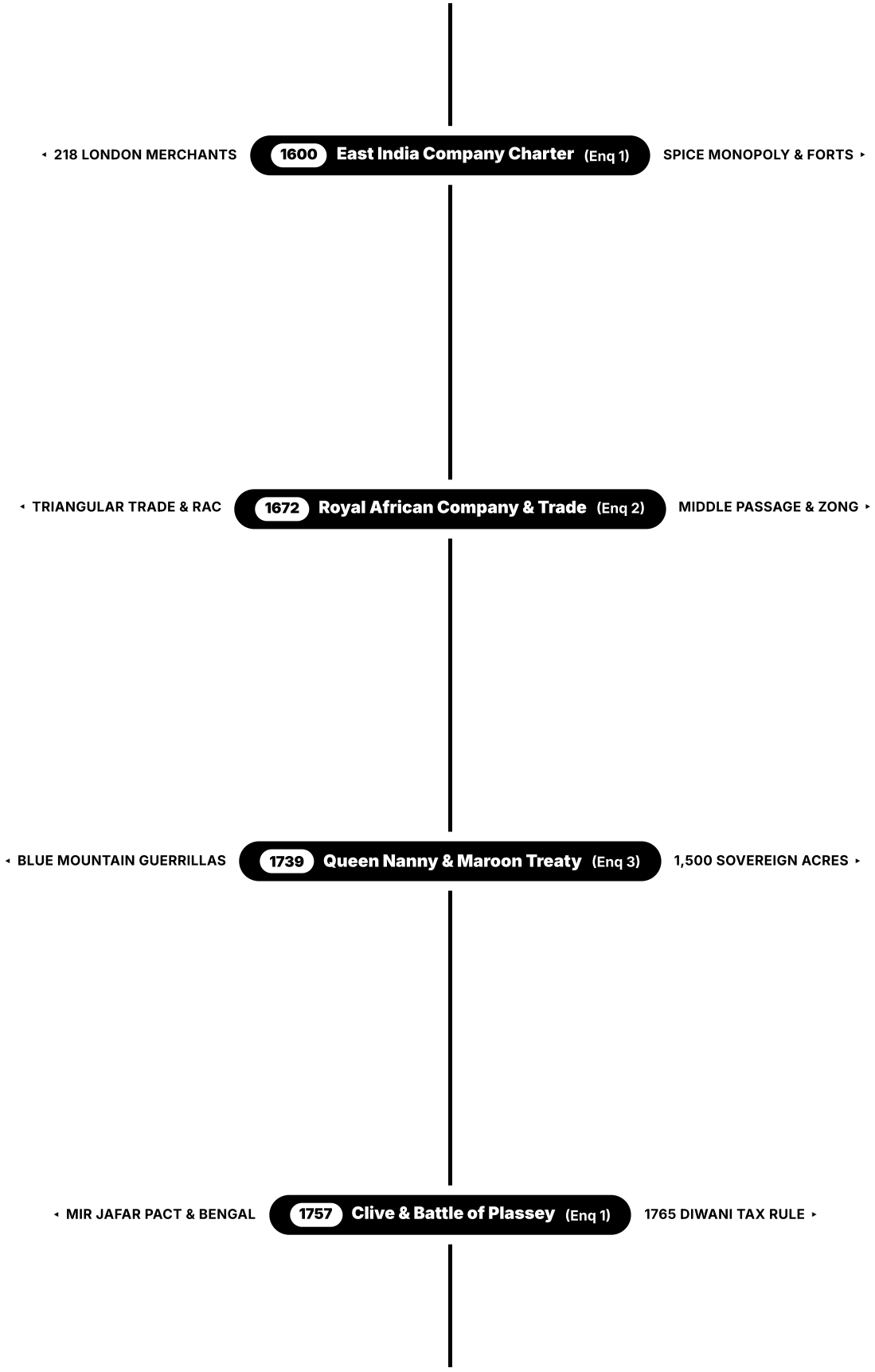
MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1739 Queen Nanny & Maroon Treaty** node (1655 Jamaica conquest, Blue Mountain guerrilla tactics, 1,500 sovereign acres).

Trade Monopolies, The Middle Passage, Maroon Sovereignty & Plassey

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Charters & Bondage to the left • Resistance & Conquest to the right).



CURRICULUM SPINE CONTINUES TO STAMP ACT, TEA PARTY & 1783 (PAGE 9) ➔

Imperial Taxation, Boston Tea Party, 1776 Declaration & Black Loyalists

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Taxes & Protests to the left • War, Paradox & 1783 Peace to the right).

◂ £133M SEVEN YEARS DEBT — **1765 Stamp Act & Colonial Protest** (Enq 4) — NO TAX WITHOUT VOTE ▸

◂ EIC TEA ACT MONOPOLY — **1773 Boston Tea Party & Coercion** (Enq 4) — 342 CHESTS & PORT SHUT ▸

◂ JEFFERSON'S EQUALITY CRY — **1776 Declaration & Moral Paradox** (Enq 5) — SLAVERY & DUNMORE OFFER ▸

◂ FRENCH FLEET AT YORKTOWN — **1783 Treaty of Paris & Loyalists** (Enq 5) — 3,000 BOOK OF NEGROES ▸

FIRST BRITISH EMPIRE CURRICULUM SPINE COMPLETE (1600–1783) ➔

Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1763 • Why did British victory in the Seven Years' War create imperial conflict?

- £133m Imperial War Debt
- Proclamation Line of 1763
- Standing Army Quartering

2 1765–1766 • Why did the Stamp Act provoke the cry "No taxation without representation"?

- Taxing Legal Documents
- Attacking Stamp Collectors
- Colonial Import Boycotts

3 March 1770 • How was the Boston Massacre transformed into revolutionary propaganda?

- Snowballs, Ice & Oysters
- Five Dead Colonists
- Paul Revere's Engraving

4 May 1773 • Why did the 1773 Tea Act provoke outrage even though it lowered tea prices?

- 18m Pounds Surplus Tea
- East India Company Monopoly
- Bypassing Local Merchants

5 Dec 1773 • How did the Boston Tea Party shatter relations between Britain and America?

- Sons of Liberty Mohawks
- 342 Chests Smashed Open
- Punitive Coercive Acts

Colonists were so careful during the Boston Tea Party that they swept the deck clean and replaced a broken padlock.

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

DISCIPLINARY DRILL

Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the Stamp Act (1765) to the Boston Tea Party (1773). [8 marks]

Connectives: The sequence began when… • This produced immediate opposition because… • Tensions escalated further when… • A decisive turning point occurred when… • As a direct result…

Question 3: Explain Importance [8 marks • 10 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain the importance of the Boston Tea Party (1773) for relations between Britain and the American colonies. [8 marks]

Analytical Connectives: *The primary importance was that… • In response, imperial authorities decided to… • Crucially, this had the effect of… • Consequently, relations deteriorated because…*

Key Terms: Boston Tea Party • King George III • Coercive Acts (Intolerable Acts) • Boston Harbour • General Gage • Continental Congress

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 9** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1765 Stamp Act** and **1773 Boston Tea Party** nodes (war debt, Boston Massacre, 342 tea chests & Coercive Acts).

How did the ideals of the 1776 Revolution contrast with the reality of slavery and imperial defeat?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1775 • How did Lexington, Concord, and Dunmore's Proclamation start the war?

- Paul Revere Midnight Alarm
- The Shot Heard Round the World
- Dunmore's Freedom Offer

2 July 1776 • What central moral paradox lay at the heart of the 1776 Declaration?

- Jefferson's Eagle Quill
- All Men Created Equal
- Slaveholder Signatories

3 1777–1780 • How did Saratoga and the French alliance turn the rebellion into a global war?

- Defeating General Burgoyne
- King Louis XVI Warships
- Sugar Island Divergence

4 October 1781 • How did French naval power force General Cornwallis to surrender at Yorktown?

- Cornwallis Peninsula Trap
- De Grasse Chesapeake Blockade
- The World Turned Upside Down

5 1783 • How did the Treaty of Paris and the Black Loyalists conclude the First Empire?

- American Independence Treaty
- Book of Negroes Ledgers
- Nova Scotia Evacuation Ships

Thomas Jefferson wrote 'all men are created equal' while personally owning over 170 enslaved people.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

'British defeat in the American Revolutionary War was caused primarily by French naval intervention rather than American military strength.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The Battle of Saratoga and the French Alliance (1777–1778)** | **George Washington and the Continental Army at Valley Forge**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

1. EXTERNAL INTERVENTION	2. COLONIAL CAMPAIGN	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Explain how international military and naval intervention affected Britain's ability to conduct the war.	Explain how local military tactics, strategic leadership, and resilience sustained the conflict.	Weigh which factor was more decisive in bringing about imperial surrender and the recognition of independence.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A compelling argument supporting this statement is that... • In particular, naval factors were significant because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • Crucially, ground campaigns demonstrated that... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

George Washington • Continental Army • Saratoga (1777) • French Alliance • King Louis XVI • Admiral de Grasse • General Cornwallis • Siege of Yorktown (1781) • Treaty of Paris (1783)

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 9** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1776 Declaration Paradox** and **1783 Treaty of Paris & Black Loyalists** nodes (Yorktown siege, Book of Negroes).

NOTES • REVISION & ASSESSMENT PLANNING

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

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KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET KS3 LEVEL:** _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA

YEARS 7–9 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–5)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Identifies key names, dates, and terms; describes what happened using simple statements and structured writing frames.	Describes reasons why events occurred; begins to explain causes and consequences supported by basic historical facts.	Constructs structured paragraphs explaining multiple causes and consequences; substantiates arguments with precise historical dates, key terms, and named figures.	Weighs competing factors and perspectives; explains why certain causes were more decisive than others using detailed, accurate evidence across the unit.	Crafts sustained, analytically rigorous arguments reaching a substantiated historical judgement; masterfully synthesizes evidence across the unit to evaluate complex turning points and long-term significance.

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	DO NOW (/5)	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: East India Company & Bengal Causal Explanation: Expansion of Control (1600–1765)	/ 5		
	Enquiry 2: Transatlantic Slave Trade Feature Drill & Consequence: Middle Passage & Zong	/ 5		
	Enquiry 3: Maroon Resistance in Jamaica Contrasting Interpretations: Queen Nanny & Resistance	/ 5		
	Enquiry 4: Thirteen Colonies & Tea Party Narrative Account & Importance: Boston Escalation	/ 5		
	Enquiry 5: American Revolution & 1783 Evaluative Judgement: Turning point in Imperial Defeat	/ 5		
	Independent Study & Notes Portfolio Pages 14–15 Enquiry Notes, Reflection & Revision Tasks	—		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task	—		
★	**UNIT RETRIEVAL STARTER TOTAL:**	/ 25	Overall Retrieval Grade: [Emerging • Expected • Greater Depth]	

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
East India Co.	Slave Trade	Maroon Resistance	Boston Tea Party	1776 Revolution
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]

From Bengal to Boston, commercial exploitation and imperial taxation provoked rebellion and transformed the globe.